Derick Janssen

An award-winning gameplay programmer who is passionate about gameplay, feel, tools, performance, and multiplayer. Excels at rapid prototyping and communication.

Email:
zorakbane@yahoo.com
This resume was created by a human for humans. Please ask for the AI one.

EXPERIENCE

Santa Barbara Games, Remote - *Principal Engineer*
Jan 2025 - Current

Wicked Fox Games, Remote - *Senior/Lead Programmer*
May 2024 - Jan 2026

Studio Wildcard, Remote - *Senior Programmer*
Feb 2024 - May 2024

Bethesda Game Studios, Dallas, TX — *Senior/Lead Programmer*
June 2016 - January 2024

S2 Games, Kalamazoo, MI— *Senior Programmer*
June 2012 - June 2016

Evolutionary Games, Orlando, FL— *Programmer*
July 2008 - May 2010

EDUCATION

SMU Guildhall, TX — *Interactive Technology* **- 3.5**
2010-2012, Full Scholarship Awarded

An intense masters program where we built our own engine and renderer from the ground up. We also learned and created multiple games in different engines (Torque, UDK, and proprietary engines)

UCF, FL — *BS Computer Science - 3.64*
2007 - 2010, Presidents List

UCF combined Electrical Engineering and Computer Science so I learned a lot about Electrical Engineering as well as Computer Science while taking a focus on Artificial Intelligence (even graduate level) courses

YouTube and other Media
Always - Forever

I follow all sorts of programming and math/science channels! Tell me your favorites. Always stay learning and curious!

SKILLS

Agentic Coding, AI (general)
Unreal, Unity, XNA, Torque

AWARDS

Finalist in the Indie Games Challenge *Galactic Arms Race*

Full Scholarship Awarded to SMU Guildhall from Indie Games Challenge at DICE convention 2010 in Las Vegas

Upsilon Pi Epsilon
Member of the Computer Science honors society

Pi Mu Epsilon
Member of the Mathematics honors society

Steam VR Game of the Year & Golden Joystick Award
Skyrim VR 2018

XBox Game of the Year &

Most Innovative Gameplay Award
Starfield 2023

LANGUAGES

C++ C# C
Lua, ActionScript, Blueprint
Java, or whatever language

English
Some Spanish
Some Japanese

PROJECTS (Reverse Chronological)

Voidwood - *Unity C#*
Owner of the Deterministic Multiplayer Rollback Netcode simulation in ECS. Created a V-Rising size world with a mean simulation time of ~1.5ms. Ensured a performant build with no crashes or desyncs and at each milestone. Created many tools for the team and productivity. Created Agentic AI workflows for non-coders.

Rise of Elements - *Unity C#*
I worked on client/server game logic, UI, and tools. I've worked on nearly every aspect of the game except backend AWS server scaling.

Ark Survival Ascended - *UE5 C++*
I helped with optimization, tools, and bug fixes. I gained 25% server performance in my first week! I identified problems with nanite/Lumen performance that severely limited client framerate.

Starfield — *Proprietary C++ Engine*
I worked as a lead for the StarMap feature. I later worked on Ship Building, Localization, Optimizations, and Outposts.

UNANNOUNCED — *Unity ECS (canned) and UE4 GAS*
Can't talk much about this one (NDA). A multiplayer third person game.

Fallout 76 — *Proprietary C++ Engine*
I was brought on to ship some post release features, namely bulldozing, vending, and camp decorating. I also worked on the Nuclear Winter game mode.

Skyrim VR — *Proprietary C++ Engine*
I spearheaded this VR project from conception until launch. I worked on pretty much every feature of the game except the zoomed out map mode and tutorial.

Fallout VR — *Proprietary C++ Engine*
I created melee, polished teleporting and movement, created the workshop mode in VR, and many new UI elements in AS3

Force of Elements — *Proprietary AS3 Engine*
I helped a friend ship a multiplayer versus puzzle fighter game.

Savage: Resurrection — *UE4*
A 1st and 3rd person FPS RTS game. I did all of the commander coding, all of the combat and gun/spell logic, cosmetics, some UI, character controls, etc.

SPEECHES
KVCC - Game industry primer

GR Dev Night - Game development (**sold out)**

MSU - How to transition from education to industry

WMU - So you want to make games?

UCF - Galactic Arms Race - NEAT(AI) and Making games with it

OTHER DEVELOPMENTS
Project M(3.0) — Wii
Homebrew App - Front end launcher and updater

UEFN Game prototyping, many games in UEFN

Ninja Survivors - UE5 - Lead Programmer - a Vampire Survivors clone done in Unreal GAS

Alchemy Avenue - UE4 - Lead Programmer - a mobile game done in blueprint to teach covid19 furloughed friends game development.

NFC Amiibo data — a github I started to reverse engineer Amiibos and their data

Game Jams! I try to do at least a game jam a year.

Strife — *Proprietary C++ Engine*

A top down “Second Generation” MOBA game. I worked closely with designers and implemented ways for them to achieve things they wanted. I also wrote a proprietary “conductor” dynamic music system, shader graph builder UI, and other tools

Chroma — *UDK and Unreal Script*

A 3rd person multiplayer deathmatch game featuring wall-walking
I did all the programming.

Puppies In Spaaace! — *UDK and Unreal Script*

A first person shooter featuring a dog with shoulder mounted tennis ball launchers and a 3 stage boss battle against a vacuum cleaner piloted by a cat. I did all the programming

Cell — *Torque 2D then XNA*

A 2D puzzle arcade shooter. I did all the programming

Galactic Arms Race — *XNA*

This is a multiplayer Diablo-esque looter shooter.
This game is also a thesis for cgNeat (content generation with AI). I worked on a number of gameplay elements and integrated ANN to gameplay.

Game Jams (Reverse Chronological)

Bonsai — *2023 Global Game Jam - Unity*

A zen game about pruning an always growing bonsai tree

Reflection — *2022 Global Game Jam - UE4*

A psychological puzzle-platformer adventure

Lineage — *2022 Global Game Jam - UE4*

A side scroller action-adventure game set in the distant past of ancient Persia

The Coven — *2021 Global Game Jam - UE4*

An asymmetric 4v1 game, where four witches are looking to find and banish their fallen sister turned wraith.

Alchemy Avenue — *2020 Global Game Jam*

You're an Alchemist/Apothecary! Brew potions to cure curses and illnesses for customers.

Fire Season — *2019 DSOP Spoopy Game Jam - **Unity ECS***

A Gauntlet and Doom crossover game

When I still knew You — *2019 Global Game Jam - Unity*

A narrative-driven platforming game telling the story of an old man battling dementia

Kronium Mogul — *2018 Global Game Jam - Proprietary*

Space trade empire game. colonize planets, mine resources and stuff

Saturn Skipper — *2017 Global Game Jam - Unity*

An asymmetrical VS game where one whale hunter in VR plays against a space narwhal

Late To Work Simulator — *2016 Global Game Jam - UE4*

A tri-lane game that gets incrementally faster

Comm Room — *GGJ 2015, Unity*

Two players must work together to escape the planet. One is navigating, one is escaping.

Today I… — *GGJ 2014 Unity*

An open world game that spans across multiple days, events from previous days affect the next days

Fire and Ice — *GGJ 2012*

A two player arcade game where you play as fire and ice phoenix and perform circles to collect points

Johny Apple Siege — *Guildhall Game Jam 2011 - C# XNA*

A grid-based Tower-Defense game against bugs. I Hosted the event and used my engine wrapper.